

8 NIGHTS • 9 DAYS • ITALY • HISTORY, FOOD & WINE TRAIL

La Dolce Vita: History & Vines

An epicurean odyssey traversing Roman imperial wonders, sun-drenched Brunello vineyards in Val d'Orcia, Renaissance masterpieces in Florence, and candlelit canals in Venice.

⊕ Rome (3N) → Tuscany / Val d'Orcia (2N) → Florence (2N) → Venice (1N) → Out ✈

EXPEDITION PARAMETERS



DURATION
8N / 9D
Grand Classic Pace



PARTY SIZE
2 - 6 Guests
Private Chauffeur &
Guide



PACING
**Epicurean
Leisure**
Frecciarossa
Executive



STYLE
**Bespoke
Luxury**
Palazzos & Wine
Estates

CURATED JOURNEY OUTLINE

Journey Blueprint

Italy is an intoxicating celebration of civilization, terroir, and the culinary arts. This bespoke 9-day grand tour begins amidst the imperial ruins and candlelit trattorias of **Rome**, winds into the cypress-lined hills of **Tuscany & Val d'Orcia** for private Brunello di Montalcino cellar tastings, immerses you in the cradle of the Renaissance in **Florence** with private Uffizi access, and culminates in the floating Byzantine palazzos of **Venice**. Seamlessly choreographed with private Mercedes transfers and Frecciarossa high-speed rail.

THE ROUTE

Rome (3N) → Val d'Orcia / Montalcino (2N) → Florence (2N) → Venice (1N) → Venice Marco Polo Departure.

ACCOMMODATION

Hotel de Russie / Hotel Eden (Rome), Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco (Tuscany), Belmond Villa San Michele (Florence), The Gritti Palace (Venice).

PRIVATE TRANSIT & RAIL

Chauffeured Mercedes-Benz V-Class for regional trails plus Frecciarossa Executive Class high-speed train & private Venetian water taxi.

WINE & CULINARY INCLUSIONS

Daily artisanal breakfasts, private Vatican early-access breakfast, 2 exclusive vineyard estate sommelier lunches, and bistecca dining.

YOUR 9 DAYS AT A GLANCE



NIGHTS ALLOCATION

8 NIGHTS TOTAL



SIGNATURE HIGHLIGHTS

DAY 02 HIGHLIGHT

VIP Early Access Sistine Chapel Before Public Gates

DAY 04 HIGHLIGHT

Private Brunello di Montalcino Barrel Tasting

DAY 07 HIGHLIGHT

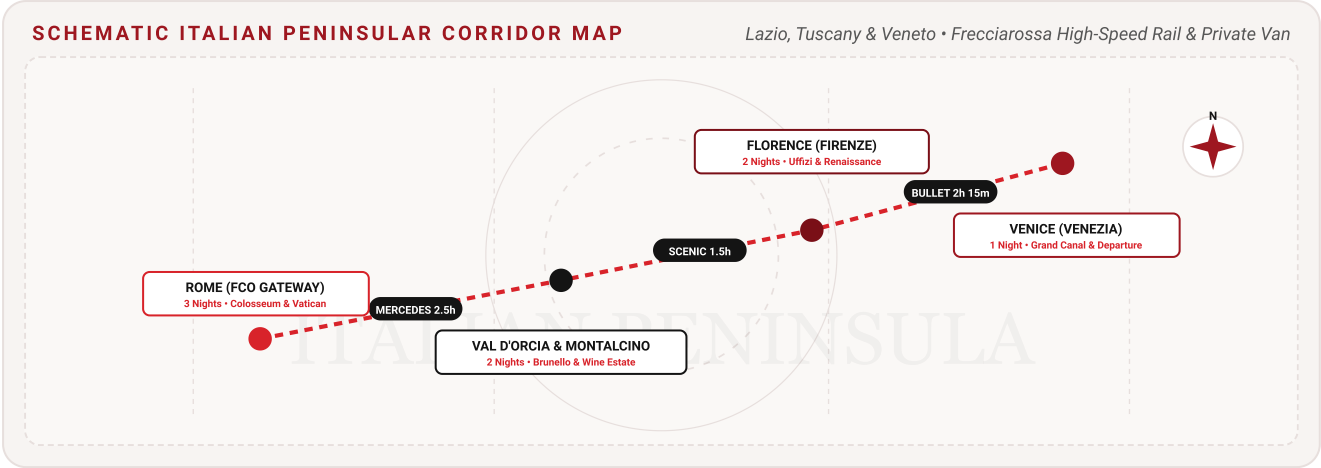
Chianti Truffle Hunt & Bistecca alla Fiorentina Feast

DAY 08 HIGHLIGHT

Grand Canal Private Mahogany Water Taxi Cruise

GEOGRAPHIC TRAJECTORY

Route Topology & Culinary Schedule



CULINARY PROVISIONING

DAY	BASE STAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Day 01	Hotel de Russie / Eden, Rome	— In Flight	— Piazza Navona Cafe	✔ Roman Welcome Trattoria
Day 02	Hotel de Russie / Eden, Rome	✔ Vatican Pinecone Courtyard	— Borgo Pio Artisanal Panini	— At Leisure (Campo de' Fiori)
Day 03	Hotel de Russie / Eden, Rome	✔ Hotel Buffet	— Testaccio Market Tastings	✔ Trastevere Food & Wine Walk
Day 04	Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco	✔ Hotel Buffet	✔ Brunello Vineyard Lunch	✔ Estate Tuscan Dinner
Day 05	Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco	✔ Estate Breakfast	— Pienza Pecorino Tasting	— Montepulciano Hilltop Oenoteca
Day 06	Belmond Villa San Michele / Portrait	✔ Included	— San Lorenzo Central Market	✔ Arno River Panorama Dinner
Day 07	Belmond Villa San Michele / Portrait	✔ Included	✔ Chianti Truffle Hunt Lunch	✔ Bistecca alla Fiorentina Feast
Day 08	The Gritti Palace, Venice	✔ Included	— Frecciarossa Executive Dining	✔ Venetian Cicchetti & Lagoon Dine
Day 09	Homeward Bound • Out	✔ Grand Canal Terrace	— Venice Airport Lounge	— In Flight Service

*Note: Meals marked as — give you complete freedom to discover wood-fired pizzerias, artisan gelaterias, and historic bacari wine bars at your own pace.



The Eternal City: Imperial Grandeur & Culinary Soul

ROME, VATICAN CITY & HISTORIC TRASTEVERE

DAYS 01 - 03

DAY

01



Arrival in Rome & Twilight Stroll by Trevi & Pantheon

 **Base:** Rome

 **Stay:** Hotel de Russie / Hotel Eden

 **Meals:** Welcome Dinner

- ◆ Arrive at Rome Fiumicino Airport (FCO); private Mercedes-Benz transfer to your 5-star hotel near Piazza del Popolo or the Spanish Steps.
- ◆ Late afternoon guided walk through Rome's historic cobblestone lanes, stopping to toss a coin into the **Trevi Fountain** and admiring the illuminated oculus of the **Pantheon**.
- ◆ Indulge in a curated welcome dinner featuring Roman classics: authentic hand-tossed cacio e pepe, artichokes alla giudia, and rich Frascati Superiore wines.

DAY

02



VIP Early-Access Vatican, Sistine Chapel & St. Peter's

 **Base:** Rome

 **Stay:** Hotel de Russie / Hotel Eden

 **Meals:** Vatican Courtyard Breakfast

- ◆ Exclusive 07:30 AM early entrance into the **Vatican Museums**; savor an American-style buffet breakfast in the serene Pinecone Courtyard before public crowds enter.
- ◆ Stand in tranquil contemplation beneath Michelangelo's legendary frescoes inside the **Sistine Chapel**, followed by private access to the Raphael Rooms and **St. Peter's Basilica**.
- ◆ Afternoon at leisure exploring high-fashion boutiques along Via Condotti or relaxing in the private tiered terraced gardens of Hotel de Russie.

DAY

03



Colosseum Gladiator Floor & Trastevere Culinary Trail

 **Base:** Rome

 **Stay:** Hotel de Russie / Hotel Eden

 **Meals:** Breakfast, Trastevere Tasting Tour

- ◆ Walk through the restricted gladiatorial arena gate of the **Colosseum**, followed by an expert archaeologist-led exploration of the **Roman Forum** and Palatine Hill.
- ◆ Afternoon visit to the lively Testaccio food market, sampling aged 24-month Parmigiano Reggiano, prosciutto di San Daniele, and crispy suppli rice croquettes.
- ◆ Evening progressive culinary tour across ivy-draped **Trastevere**, sampling artisanal craft beers, natural Lazio wines, homemade rigatoni all'amatriciana, and artisanal pistachio gelato.



Rolling Cypress Hills, Brunello Terroir & Renaissance Florence

VAL D'ORCIA, MONTALCINO, CHIANTI & THE CRADLE OF THE ARTS

DAYS 04 - 06

DAY

04
☆

Rome to Val d'Orcia: Brunello Cellars & Montalcino

📍 **Base:** Tuscany (Val d'Orcia)

🏠 **Stay:** Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco

🍽️ **Meals:** Breakfast, Vineyard Lunch, Dinner

- ◆ Private chauffeured journey north into UNESCO-listed **Val d'Orcia**, driving past iconic rolling wheat hills, winding cypress avenues, and medieval stone farmhouses.
- ◆ Private cellar tour and barrel tasting at an esteemed **Brunello di Montalcino** estate, followed by a multi-course paired Tuscan luncheon overlooking olive groves.
- ◆ Check in to your luxury suite at Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco; spend the evening unwinding by the heated infinity pool overlooking the undulating hills of Montalcino.

DAY

05
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Pienza Pecorino Tasting & Montepulciano Nobile

📍 **Base:** Tuscany (Val d'Orcia)

🏠 **Stay:** Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco

🍽️ **Meals:** Breakfast

- ◆ Morning visit to the Renaissance utopian town of **Pienza**; meet a master cheesemaker for private tastings of walnut-aged and truffle-infused Pecorino di Pienza.
- ◆ Ascend to medieval **Montepulciano**; descend into subterranean 16th-century vaulted cantinas to taste Vino Nobile di Montepulciano straight from Slavonian oak barrels.
- ◆ Late afternoon panoramic photography stop at the Chapel of Vitaleta, followed by an evening at leisure dining at a Michelin-starred village osteria.

DAY

06
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San Gimignano Towers to Florence & Ponte Vecchio

📍 **Base:** Florence (Firenze)

🏠 **Stay:** Belmond Villa San Michele / Portrait

🍽️ **Meals:** Breakfast, Arno River Dinner

- ◆ Drive north pausing in the walled medieval Manhattan of **San Gimignano**; savor Vernaccia white wine and world-champion saffron gelato from Gelateria Dondoli.
- ◆ Arrive in **Florence**; check in to your riverside palace overlooking the Arno or a former 15th-century monastery in Fiesole with sweeping skyline views.
- ◆ Evening sunset stroll across the **Ponte Vecchio** and Piazza della Signoria, concluding with a candlelit Florentine dinner along the banks of the Arno River.

Florentine Masters, Chianti Truffles & Venetian Waters

UFFIZI GALLERY, CHIANTI CLASSICO & THE GRAND CANAL

DAYS 07 - 09

DAY
07
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VIP Uffizi, Chianti Truffle Hunt & Bistecca Feast

Base: Florence (Firenze)

Stay: Belmond Villa San Michele / Portrait

Meals: Breakfast, Truffle Lunch, Bistecca

- ◆ Skip-the-line private VIP tour of the **Uffizi Gallery** admiring Botticelli's *Birth of Venus* and da Vinci's masterpieces with an art historian.
- ◆ Midday excursion into the Chianti hills for a private **Truffle Hunt with trained dogs**, followed by fresh hand-shaved truffle tagliolini and Chianti Classico Gran Selezione.
- ◆ Return to Florence for an epicurean grand finale: dry-aged, wood-grilled **Bistecca alla Fiorentina** paired with vintage Super Tuscan red wines.

DAY
08
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Frecciarossa to Venice & Private Grand Canal Water Taxi

Base: Venice (Venezia)

Stay: The Gritti Palace, A Luxury Collection

Meals: Breakfast, Cicchetti Tasting Dinner

- ◆ Board the **Frecciarossa 1000 High-Speed Train (Executive Class)** from Florence to Venice Santa Lucia (2h 15m), gliding directly onto the Venetian Lagoon.
- ◆ Step directly into a private classic varnished mahogany **water taxi** cruising the Grand Canal under the Rialto Bridge straight to the private pier of The Gritti Palace.
- ◆ Sunset private gondola glide through tranquil inner canals, followed by a guided bacaro tour tasting traditional **Venetian Cicchetti**, baccalà mantecato, and crisp Prosecco di Valdobbiadene.

DAY
09
✈

St. Mark's Basilica & Private Water Taxi to Marco Polo

Base: Departure Hub

Meals: Grand Canal Terrace Breakfast

- ◆ Morning cappuccino and warm cornetto on the outdoor terrace overlooking Santa Maria della Salute; VIP skip-the-line visit to the golden mosaics of **St. Mark's Basilica** and Doge's Palace.
- ◆ Private motorboat water taxi transfer directly across the glittering open lagoon to Venice Marco Polo Airport (VCE) dock for your outbound journey.
- ◆ Carry home memories of Roman marble, amber Tuscan sunsets, golden vintage cellars, and the timeless magic of Italy.

Until the next journey.

Every trail curated with personal reverence for the landscapes we love.

— CLEAR & TRANSPARENT TERMS

What Is Included & Excluded

✓ WHAT IS INCLUDED	✕ WHAT IS EXCLUDED
☐ 8 Nights Luxury 5-Star Stays 3N Hotel de Russie / Eden Rome, 2N Rosewood Castiglion del Bosco Val d'Orcia, 2N Belmond / Portrait Florence, 1N The Gritti Palace Venice.	 International Long-Haul Airfare Inbound flights into Rome (FCO) and outbound flights from Venice (VCE); can be booked via our flight desk.
☐ Chauffeured Mercedes V-Class & Rail Dedicated NCC licensed chauffeur for Rome-Tuscany-Florence legs, Frecciarossa Executive Class rail, and private Venetian water taxi.	 Schengen Visa & ETIAS Fees Consular Schengen visa processing fees, ETIAS electronic travel authorization, and courier charges.
 VIP Priority Access & Historians Pre-opening Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel tour, Colosseum Arena Floor, Uffizi Gallery, and St. Mark's Basilica skip-the-line passes.	☐ City Tourist Taxes (Tassa di Soggiorno) Mandatory municipal tourist hotel taxes payable directly at hotel check-out (€7 to €10 per person/night).
☐ Sommelier Tastings & Truffle Hunt Private Brunello di Montalcino estate cellar tasting, Chianti truffle hunting experience with private chef lunch, and Pienza cheese tasting.	 Rare Vintage Cellar Upgrades Ultra-premium vintage Brunello Riservas and Super Tuscans (e.g. Sassicaia, Masseto) outside stated sommelier flights.
 Curated Dining Experiences Daily European breakfast buffets, Vatican courtyard breakfast, Trastevere food walk, and Bistecca alla Fiorentina signature dinner.	 Travel & Medical Insurance Comprehensive international trip cancellation, baggage loss, and emergency medical insurance.

OPTIONAL BESPOKE ENHANCEMENTS AVAILABLE

-  Upgrade to a self-drive vintage Alfa Romeo Spider across the Val d'Orcia, arrange private after-hours access to the Vasari Corridor in Florence, or book a private wooden Riva boat charter to Murano & Burano.

— THE MAD COMPASS WAY

How We Bring Your Journey To Life

1

Personalized Consultation

We listen to your preferred wine appellations, architectural interests, and culinary aspirations to sculpt an authentic itinerary.

2

Fine-Tuning & Precision

We secure coveted Uffizi and Vatican private slots, reserve licensed NCC drivers for restricted ZTL zones, and curate private cellar visits.

3

Seamless Execution & 24/7 Care

From your Rome Fiumicino arrival to Venice water taxi departure, our dedicated European operations desk oversees every detail 24/7.

Flexible Amendments & Bespoke Guarantee: All Mad Compass private signature itineraries across Italy feature flexible amendment protocols, licensed private access permits into historic ZTL zones, and on-ground concierge support throughout your journey.

Ready when you are.

Let us calibrate this Italian history, food & wine trail to your exact dates, party preferences, and travel style.

📞 +91 97111 93458

✉ hello@madcompass.com

🌐 madcompass.com

📍 Kolkata, India

12+

YEARS ACTIVE IN CURATION

300+

SIGNATURE TRIPS PLANNED

25+

EXOTIC DESTINATIONS